

Week 22: Archaeology

BIG IDEA

Archaeology shows the Bible is not just inspired but genuinely historical. Like a signature or an artifact, physical finds — coins pointing to King David, an inscription naming Pontius Pilate — tie the biblical text to real history, making its story that much more reliable and more powerful for students.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Ancient cities collapsed and were rebuilt on their own rubble; archaeologists dig down through these layers, called tells, into successively older time periods.
- The signature introduction activity shows how clues date a find: marker, whiteboard, and identity together let you place roughly when it happened.
- Your storyteller needn't be an archaeologist; someone who found a family heirloom shows how an artifact makes a story both more reliable and more powerful.
- In small groups, drive home that the Bible is also history: coins indicate David really was a king, and an inscription names Pontius Pilate.
- Expect pushback like 'isn't this just stories and myths?' — watch for those questions and be ready to talk them through.
- If this evidence is new to you too, say so; students need to see this is a journey you are walking together.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Two weeks in, what does the manuscript and archaeological evidence do for how you see the Bible?
2. How does connecting a story to a physical artifact change how much you trust the story?
3. What archaeological finds mentioned this week surprised you, and why?
4. If the Bible is real history and not just stories, what difference does that make for your life?

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